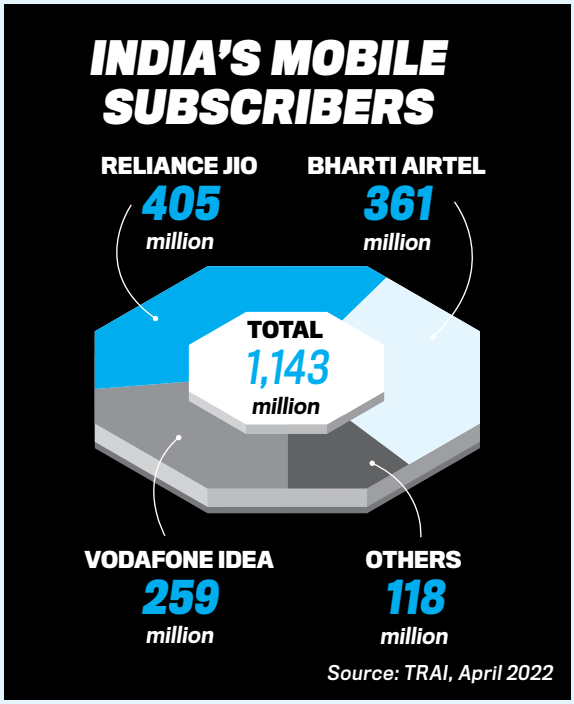
INDIA'S MOBILE SUBSCRIBERS



Source: TRAI, April 2022

WHO BID HOW MUCH?

Reliance Jio	Bharti Airtel	Vodafone Idea	Adani Group
88,078	43,084	18,799	212*

Figures in Rs crore; *for captive use
Source: Media reports

TELCOS' 5G PLANS

VODAFONE IDEA
Partnering with US-based Ciena to construct a future-ready network. It has also tied up with L&T Smart World & Communication for 5G network infrastructure, based on technology expertise from Nokia

BHARTI AIRTEL
Has roped in Tech Mahindra to create and market enterprise-grade digital solutions spanning 5G, private networks and the cloud. It is also in talks with equipment providers to negotiate 5G contracts

RELIANCE JIO
In advanced talks with South Korea's Samsung as a third-party service provider. It is also collaborating with Google Cloud for 5G

BSNL
Not available

ADANI
Not available



"THE TRANSITION FROM 3G TO 4G WAS NOT VERY DIFFICULT. THE DATA SPEED IMPROVED... **AND REMOTE WAYS OF WORKING BECAME THE NORM. WITH 5G, ALL THIS IS GOING TO INCREASE EXPONENTIALLY"**

–K.G. PURUSHOTHAMAN,
Partner, KPMG India

THE TARIFFS QUESTION

A key question concerning the general public is how expensive 5G would be. Experts say there are two kinds of costs to consider. One is the cost of the actual connection, and the other is what the customer pays for the content. "What normally gets reported is only the telecommunications costs," says Purushothaman. "India has one of the lowest telecom costs in the world. When the rollout happens, India being a price-sensitive market, service providers will bundle 5G with exclusive content." Despite the high consumption of data, revenues from mobile telephony in India are among the lowest in the world. Data usage rose at a compounded annual growth rate of 53 per cent between 2017 and 2021, according to a report released by Nokia last year. India's monthly data consumption touched 17 GB per user in 2021, a year-on-year increase of 26.6 per cent. But average revenue per user (ARPU) per month has been languishing. In March 2022, Airtel reported the highest ARPU of Rs 178, Reliance Jio of Rs 167.6 and Vodafone Idea of Rs 124. In contrast, China had an ARPU of RMB47.5 (Rs 561.51) for the first quarter of 2022. "Data and voice consumption six